

Replying to your reviews

What the system does

Three things run on their own, without anyone opening anything.

It watches your listings

Your Google Business Profile is checked every 15 minutes, along with DealerRater and Carfax where those apply. A review is picked up within minutes of a customer leaving it, including star-only reviews with no comment, which still move your rating.

It writes a reply

A draft is written in your dealership's voice: the customer's first name, nothing invented about their visit, and a length that suits the review. A five star "great service" gets a short thank-you. A complaint gets an answer that acknowledges the specific problem.

It emails the draft to you

Nothing is ever published on its own. The draft goes to one named approver, and the reply appears on Google only after that person approves it.

One person decides

Only the approver's email carries the Approve and Edit buttons. Everyone else who is copied gets the same review and the same draft to read, with no buttons, so two people can never approve the same reply from two inboxes.

The approval email

Subject line: Review reply ready, #A1B2C3. Here is what is inside it.

Review reply ready for your approval

RATING ★★★★★ (5/5)

CUSTOMER Sarah M.

DEALERSHIP BMW of Fort Walton Beach
[View Google Business Profile](#)

"Second car I've bought here. Ask for Danny, no pressure at all."

Drafted reply

Thank you, Sarah, and thank you for coming back to us. I'll pass this straight on to Danny. Enjoy the new car.

Approve

Edit

PART	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Rating	The stars the customer left. Absent when the platform does not publish a rating for each review.
Customer	The reviewer's name as it appears publicly. "Anonymous" when they left none.
Dealership	Which of your locations the review is for, with a direct link to that location's Google Business Profile underneath.
Review	The customer's words, exactly as written. Star-only reviews say so instead.
Drafted reply	What will be posted if you approve it unchanged.
Reference	The number for this one draft. Quote it if you need to ask about a specific reply.

The profile link opens the listing the way a customer sees it: the reviews, the rating, the photos. Use it when you want to check the review in place, or see how the page reads before you answer.

Approving a reply

Two clicks, and a written record of both.

1

Click Approve

A confirmation page opens asking you to confirm. Nothing has happened yet at this point, and closing the page changes nothing.

2

Confirm on that page

The reply is marked approved and queued for posting to your Google listing.

3

Check the confirmation email

Approved reply ready to post arrives immediately. It carries the approved wording, the review it answers, the date the customer left it, and a link straight to the review. It states one of the two things below.

4

Either: already posted to Google

Done. The reply is live on your listing and there is nothing further to do.

5

Or: **Ready to post**

The reply needs pasting onto the listing by hand, and the email says why. It is also waiting for you in the dashboard under Ready to post, where the wording can be copied in one click.

If you do nothing

Drafts that nobody has acted on are chased. A reminder lists every reply still waiting, how many days each has waited, and flags any that answer a 1 or 2 star review. A buried email never turns into public silence.

Editing before you send

Click **Edit** in the approval email. The dashboard opens on that exact review with the draft already loaded in the reply box.

- Change the wording however you like. It is a normal text box.
- **Generate draft** writes a fresh one if you would rather start again.
- **Approve** publishes your version through the same approval record. What you wrote is what gets posted, and nothing rewrites it afterwards.

- **Send for approval** passes it to the approver instead, for when the person writing is not the person who decides.

Edit is also the way to answer a review nobody drafted for yet. Open it from the dashboard, write the reply yourself, and approve it there.

The dashboard

Where every review lives, at /dashboard. Sign in with the email or username and password you were given.

Choosing what you are looking at

Inbox

Every review collected, newest first.

Unreplied

Reviews with no reply on the listing yet. Your working queue.

Flagged

1 and 2 star reviews. Answer these first.

Sentiment summary

What customers praise, what they complain about, and how each platform rates you.

With more than one location, the buttons at the top of the sidebar switch between them. Each location has its own queue and its own figures, and nothing is averaged across dealerships.

The four numbers across the top

NUMBER	MEANING
Google rating	Your published star average and lifetime review count, as Google shows it.
In this queue	How many reviews are in the view you are looking at.
Awaiting reply	Reviews with no answer on the listing.
Flagged	1 and 2 star reviews. These need a person, not a template.

Working through the list

- The chips under the numbers filter by platform: Google, DealerRater, Carfax. A greyed-out chip means nothing has been collected from that site yet.
-  **Open** opens the full review without leaving the page.
-  **Draft reply** writes one and puts it in front of you.
-  **Open on Google** takes you to the review on the live listing.
- **View listing on Google Maps**, beside the dealership name at the top, opens the profile itself.

Handling 1 and 2 star reviews

A negative review is the one place where the draft is a starting point rather than an answer. The system will not invent facts about what happened, because it does not know them. The draft acknowledges the problem and offers to put it right, and leaves the specifics to you.

Before you approve one

- Check what actually happened with the department involved.
- Add the one specific detail that shows you looked into it.
- Give a way to reach a real person: a name, a direct line.
- Never argue in public, and never name an employee in a negative reply.

Speed matters more here than anywhere else. A complaint answered the same day reads as a dealership that pays attention. The same words a fortnight later read as damage control.

Questions

The ones that come up in the first week.

- ▶ Can it post something without me seeing it?
- ▶ Why does a review show no star rating?
- ▶ Why do some reviews have no text?
- ▶ A review says "Not published" under Status. What does that mean?

- ▶ My dashboard is empty. Is it broken?
- ▶ Can more than one person approve?
- ▶ I approved something by mistake.
- ▶ How far back does it go?